

THE DAILY BRIEF

SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

MARKETS & FINANCE

Major market moves, economic signals, and crypto headlines

Senate Republicans release 'final' draft of Clarity Act as Trump accepts most ethics provisions. The landmark crypto market structure bill hit a critical milestone over the weekend, with Senate Banking and Agriculture committee leaders publishing a revised text that includes restrictions limiting officials and their spouses from crypto-related dealings. The bill heads toward a Tuesday cloture vote and a Wednesday floor decision. Bernstein analysts argued crypto markets are entering the vote with a "bearish bias" and that "any positive surprise is definitely not priced in," setting up a potential asymmetric setup. (The Block)

Strategy repurchases 139 million dollars of STRC shares; holdings near 4% of all bitcoin. Michael Saylor's treasury company bought back stock in its variable-rate preferred while leaving its bitcoin stack unchanged at roughly 4% of the 21 million coin supply cap — a hoard worth around 66 billion dollars at current prices. The move signals continued institutional conviction even as CryptoQuant warns bitcoin must clear resistance at 81,700 dollars to confirm a new bull market, with a "significant range of resistance levels stretching to 88,700." (The Block)

Inflation is once again outpacing wage growth in America. August consumer prices rose 3.4% year-over-year while wages grew just 3.1%, reopening a real-income squeeze on households. Headline inflation is being driven by energy while core continues to ease, a divergence analysts say leaves the Fed little room to cut aggressively heading into its Wednesday decision. (CNBC)

Kalshi launches perpetual futures on gold and silver after CFTC approval. The prediction-market platform expanded into commodity derivatives, letting users trade continuous contracts on precious metals — a notable diversification away from event contracts and a direct shot at retail forex and futures brokerages. ESMA, meanwhile, declared that major prediction platforms "lack EU authorization" and questioned the effectiveness of partial geographic blocks used by Polymarket and Kalshi. (CNBC, The Block)

Bitcoin and ether rise even as inflation muddies the Fed outlook. Both majors climbed into the weekend as traders read the August CPI as not-strong-enough to derail rate-cut hopes but hot enough to keep the bar high. Metaplanet, the Japanese bitcoin-treasury firm, did the opposite — it reversed course on executive compensation, cutting potential share dilution by 41% and scrapping its employee warrant plan after shares fell roughly 17% over two trading sessions. (The Block)

AI & TECH

Models, labs, funding, and the people building them

OpenAI launches ChatGPT for Financial Services, targeting junior-banker workflows. The product aims squarely at the labor-intensive research, modeling, and pitchbook tasks that consume the early-career hours at banks. OpenAI also confirmed via Sam Altman it would be "ill-advised" to pursue a public listing in 2026, even after its confidential IPO filing. (CNBC, TechCrunch)

China rejects US calls for an AI slowdown as "fear mongering." Beijing's response came a day after the CEOs of Anthropic and OpenAI separately argued it is time to "pace the frontier." Chinese state media said all parties should instead work toward "AI openness and inclusivity," suggesting Beijing will not unilaterally throttle development and will treat US calls to slow down as competitive posturing. (CNBC, TechCrunch)

Larry Ellison cancels a planned 7.5 billion dollar Oracle stock sale. The Oracle founder had previously disclosed plans to sell 50 million shares. Cancellation is being read as a strong insider signal that he sees the stock moving higher. Separately, China's Ant Group is partnering with Visa and Mastercard on common technical standards for AI-agent payments, covering verification and transaction monitoring. (TechCrunch, CNBC)

Mecka AI nears a 500 million dollar valuation led by Sequoia. The two-year-old robotics-training-data startup is closing a round just months after its Series A, riding the rush to feed embodied-AI systems with high-quality motion and manipulation data. Y Combinator's Garry Tan separately called on US open-weight labs to "distill" frontier American systems to build a robust, non-Chinese open-weight ecosystem. (TechCrunch)

Anthropic and OpenAI both float a "pace the frontier" doctrine. Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei published a framework for slowing frontier development in coordination with regulators; Sam Altman echoed it on Saturday. Twenty-five leading mathematicians signed an open letter arguing AI labs are "threatening their intellectual work" by training on and reproducing research outputs without citation. The convergent signals suggest an industry-wide effort to formalize compute thresholds and safety cases is closer than it appeared six months ago. (TechCrunch)

Lyft enters the robotaxi conversation. The ride-hailing company joined Lyft-Waymo partnership talk as Ford simultaneously expanded its own autonomous efforts. Lyft is positioning as an aggregator layer over multiple AV stacks rather than building its own vehicle, a strategy that mirrors how Uber approached the space. (TechCrunch)

Khosla Ventures opens its first office outside Sand Hill Road. The Sand Hill fixture is planting a flag in New York this fall — its first outpost beyond the traditional Menlo Park corridor — signaling that AI deal flow is now flowing through both coasts. Insight Partners, separately, told TechCrunch it will keep holding positions in rival AI labs even as the rest of the industry consolidates around OpenAI and Anthropic. (TechCrunch)

BRIEFLY

< **Tesla** will finally unveil the second-generation Roadster on **October 1**, nine years after first announcing the halo sports car. (TechCrunch)

< **Sam Bankman-Fried** asked the **Supreme Court** to overturn his fraud conviction and the 11 billion dollar forfeiture, arguing he was unfairly barred from introducing solvency evidence. (The Block)

< **Revolut** confirmed a customer-data breach obtained via **fake government-domain requests**, exposing KYC info and Bitcoin transaction data for high-net-worth users. (The Block)

< **Bitwise** is shutting down its **Dogecoin ETF** less than a year after launch — BWOW generated only about 3 million dollars in volume at debut and never recovered. (The Block)

< **India's SEBI Demat 2.0 pilot** debuted with over 100 million dollars in tokenized corporate bonds settled via wholesale CBDC. (The Block)

< **Standard Chartered** initiated coverage of **Sky**, calling it "DeFi's federal bank" and projecting the SKY token could rise fivefold by end-2028. (The Block)

< **South Korea** hit 50,000 signatures on a petition to **delay the digital-asset gains tax for a fourth time** as regulators stand firm. (The Block)

THE TAKEAWAY

The two stories defining this Monday are converging on Washington. The **Clarity Act** heads toward its first procedural vote with crypto markets positioned for disappointment — Bernstein's framing of an "any positive surprise is definitely not priced in" trade is the cleanest setup I've seen in weeks, and it lands on the same day the Fed announces. Meanwhile, the AI industry has suddenly synchronized on a single message: **slow down**. Anthropic and OpenAI are both arguing out loud for "pacing the frontier," and Beijing's reply — calling US calls for a slowdown "fear mongering" — confirms that whatever governance framework emerges will be drawn along geopolitical lines, not consensus ones. For markets, that means Wednesday's Fed decision and the Clarity vote will trade as a single binary event: regulatory clarity plus monetary ease lifts risk; status quo plus a hawkish hold punishes it.

Generated by Marvin